

WRITTEN COMMENTS AND COMPLAINTS

A. Statement of Principle. The purpose of this policy is to provide guidelines for Loudoun County residents, including parents and students, for offering input, comments, suggestions, and complaints to school officials.

B. Precedence. This policy governs all written comments and complaints not governed by other policies. Procedures enumerated in other policies supersede those created in this policy.

C. Definitions

1. "Parents and students" include current students, parents of current students, or other persons who have enrolled a current student.

2. "Complainant" refers to a Loudoun County resident, including parents and/or students who have submitted a complaint.

3. "Response" means to provide a written assessment of the complaint. It does not connote a decision, agreement, or resolution.

4. "Business days" refers to days in which LCPS administrative offices are open.

D. Procedures for Addressing School-Based Concerns and Complaints

1. Whenever a complaint is made directly to the School Board, as a whole or to an individual Board member, the individual or group involved will be advised to take their concern to the appropriate staff member.

2. The Board believes that complaints and grievances are best handled and resolved as close to their origin as possible, and that staff should be given every opportunity to consider the issues and attempt to resolve the problem prior to involvement by the Board. Therefore, the proper channeling of complaints involving staff, instruction, discipline, or learning materials will be as follows, as applicable:

- a. Teacher (Coach/Director)
- b. Principal or Designee
- c. Superintendent
- d. Board

3. School principals shall establish appropriate procedures within their schools for encouraging, soliciting and receiving input, comments, suggestions and complaints from parents and students.

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E. Comment and Complaint Form

1. Loudoun County residents with comments or complaints will be provided comment and complaint form developed by the Superintendent.

2. The comment and complaint form shall be distributed at least once annually to all LCPS parents and students. Additionally, the form shall be physically accessible to Loudoun County residents in each school's office and electronically accessible either upon request or via LCPS's and individual schools' websites.

3. The comment and complaint form will record the student's school, if applicable.

4. The form will include an optional section for the complainant to categorize the complaint. In addition to offering optional preset categories, the form will also provide space for complainants to identify a category that may not be listed.

5. The School Board shall be provided full unabridged access to comments and complaints received through the LCPS comment and complaint system. A quarterly report summarizing comments and complaints received as well as their resolution status shall be provided to the School Board. All personally identifiable information shall be redacted from reports provided to the School Board.

F. Timeline

1. Persons submitting comments and/or complaints will receive an acknowledgement of receipt of a comment and complaint form in writing within 5 business days of receipt.

2. If a complaint is filed through the Comment and Complaint form, a complaint that concerns a non-school level concern will be assigned to the appropriate department in the division and receive a response within 30 calendar days of its receipt. If the complaint cannot be resolved at the department level, it will be referred to the superintendent or superintendent's designee. The decision of the superintendent or the superintendent's designee is final.

3. If filed with a principal, the principal or the principal's designee will provide a written response to complaints promptly, but no later than 30 calendar days of receipt. If the complaint cannot be resolved at the level of the principal, it is referred to the superintendent or superintendent's designee. The decision of the superintendent or the superintendent's designee is final.

G. Retaliation. Retaliation against parents, students or residents who file complaints or participate in related processes is strictly prohibited. Any alleged retaliation shall be reviewed and addressed by the appropriate administrator(s).

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H. Multiple Complaints. Multiple complaints regarding the same substantive issue, whether submitted by one or more complainant, may be treated as a single complaint for the purposes of statistical tracking and response requirements.

[Former Policy 8-10]

Adopted: 6/24/08

Revised: 1/11/11, 9/10/13

Current Revision: 05/24/22

Legal Refs: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended, §§ [22.1-87](#), [22.1-253.13:7](#)

Cross Refs: [Policy 1035](#), School Board Norms, Protocols and Violations

[Policy 2010](#), Legal Status, Authority, Powers and Duties

[Policy 2350](#), Appeal of Administrative Decisions

[Policy 2530](#), Board-Staff Communications

[Regulation 5045](#), Selection, Review And Challenge Of Instructional Resources

[Policy 7014](#), Environments Free From Harassment, Discrimination, and Abuse

[Regulation 7014](#), Environments Free From Harassment, Discrimination, and Abuse

[Policy 7016](#), Employee Complaints

[Policy 7018](#), Procedure for Adjusting Grievances

[Policy 7024](#), Classified Employee Dismissal and Demotion Grievance Procedures

[Regulation 8035](#), Title IX, Sex-Based Discrimination, Sexual Harassment